What Do You Already Know About Mom's Future Care?

Twelve quick questions about what you know. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your picture is. It doesn't measure Mom, and nothing here means she needs more help or a particular kind of care.

1. Do you have a written description of how Mom is doing today, with a date on it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you know what she does on her own in an ordinary week: bathing and dressing, meals, housework, shopping, bills and mail?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know her current diagnoses, and do you have a current list of her medications?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Have you asked the rest of the family what they've noticed about her memory, and written it down as what they saw?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. Do you know how she gets around, whether she drives, and whether she has had a fall during the past year?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know everyone who helps her now, and with what?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you know what has changed during the past year?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Has Mom told you where she'd prefer to receive care if she ever needed more help, and how important staying at home is to her?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Do you know who she wants involved in decisions, and what she'd expect from family?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Do you know the kinds of care well enough to ask about them: home care, adult day programs, assisted living, memory care, skilled nursing?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Have you written down your questions about what care costs and how it is paid for?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. Do you know which changes would be a reason to look at all of this again?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know, not how Mom is doing. A low count means there are things to find out, and most of them are a conversation or a couple of ordinary weeks of noticing away. Nothing here is medical, legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see what you know and what's still open. The care interview asks the questions that fill those gaps, area by area, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›